Exquisite Creatures Exhibit

OCI Final Report

Spring 2026

Gavin Turnmire • Christy Shen • Joy Forte • Payton Walling • Julia Powell

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Executive Summary

Christopher Marley's Exquisite Creatures Exhibit is a well-known natural art show now running at a 12,000-square-foot waterfront venue in Seattle. This is the first time in over ten years that the exhibit is being hosted independently rather than by a museum. Without a museum's marketing system, the exhibit needed help building its digital presence and getting closer to its goal of 500 visitors per day. Our team of five BYU students, Gavin Turnmire, Christy Shen, Joy Forte, Payton Walling, and Julia Powell, spent the semester working on that problem across four main areas.

Social media content creation

We started with a TikTok account that had 34 followers and about 200 views per video. In less than two months, we grew @exquisitecreatures to 619,866 total TikTok views and reached 613,188 people. Several videos went viral. The format that worked best was voiceover videos using Christopher Marley's audio over edited clips of the exhibit. The account now has a clear content strategy and a posting workflow that anyone can use to keep it growing.

Influencer outreach and platform marketing

We set up the exhibit's first RedNote account to reach Chinese-speaking audiences in Seattle, since no one had targeted that group before even though they showed real interest. For influencer marketing, we launched campaigns on JoinBrands and Afluencer. We got 14 applications, 9 from Seattle-based creators. We picked one influencer, Yana, who visited the exhibit and posted content that reached 2,500 views on Instagram and TikTok. Both campaigns are still open for new applicants.

Digital infrastructure and paid advertising

We built and launched Google Ads campaigns from the ground up. The paid search campaign generated 1,930 clicks and 14,300 impressions at $0.41 per click. The nonprofit campaign added 291 clicks and 1,880 impressions. We set up GA4 and Google Tag Manager, created SEO and AEO recommendation documents for both the Bokun site and the Christopher Marley website, and built an AI toolbox to help Exquisite Creatures handle marketing and admin work more efficiently going forward.

Tourism and transit outreach

We got the exhibit listed on Visit Seattle, which is the main tourism platform people use to find things to do in Seattle. We also started a bus advertising opportunity with King County Metro ahead of the 2026 World

Cup, when tourist traffic will be highest. A bus wrap campaign during that time could reach about 22.6 million impressions.

Combined, these workstreams produced 619,866 TikTok views, 125,917 likes, 6,425 shares, 1,930 paid search clicks, 47,582 Google Business Profile views, 36,627 profile interactions, one completed influencer collaboration, active campaigns on two influencer platforms, a Visit Seattle listing, and a full set of marketing tools and documentation for ongoing use. The exhibit now has a stronger digital foundation, more active channels, and better tools than it started with.

People Involved

Team Members

Joy Forte (Team Leader) took ownership of coordinating the group across the full semester. She scheduled weekly meetings, maintained regular contact with the sponsor, and kept the team aligned as workstream priorities shifted. On the outreach side, Joy contacted the membership board of Exquisite Creatures directly, which led to the exhibit being featured on the company website. She reached out to King County Metro's advertising team and set up meetings with their contact, Neal, to start the bus advertising process. She also managed the TikTok account during the early weeks of the semester and posted weekly to build initial momentum on the page.

Payton Walling was responsible for social media content creation across TikTok and YouTube. She created 15 TikTok posts and 4 YouTube Shorts during the semester. One of her TikTok videos went viral within two weeks of posting and currently has 183,500 views. Payton also initiated the influencer outreach effort, building a tracking spreadsheet with TikTok handles, follower counts, and pricing, and reaching out to 13 creators before handing the tracker to Christy. Earlier in the semester, she researched TripAdvisor and Google Ads as potential visibility channels and looked into how competing accounts were gaining traction.

Christy Shen led the team's influencer marketing and RedNote workstreams. She created and managed the exhibit's RedNote (Xiaohongshu) account to reach Chinese-speaking audiences in Seattle, after finding that users on the platform were already expressing interest in Exquisite Creatures and similar exhibitions. On the influencer side, she researched and tested multiple platforms before launching active campaigns on both JoinBrands and Afluencer. The campaigns drew 14 applications total, 9 from Seattle-based creators. She reviewed applicants based on content quality, engagement rates, and fit with the exhibit's brand, then managed the full collaboration process from approval through payment. One influencer, Yana, completed a collaboration that generated content across Instagram and TikTok, reaching around 2,500 views. Christy also reached out directly to influencers on Instagram and coordinated in-person visits with the exhibit's manager.

Julia Powell created 16 TikTok posts over the course of the semester and had a viral video that currently has 268,300 views. She consistently engaged with comments on each post. Earlier in the semester, Julia worked on a partnership opportunity with the Washington Getout Pass, a digital discount platform for local entertainment, which the team ultimately declined after reviewing the terms. She also worked a support case with

Google Business and Bokun to get the Exquisite Creatures booking tab properly enabled.

Gavin Turnmire was responsible for the team's digital infrastructure workstream, covering Google Ads, analytics, SEO, and AI tooling. He built the keyword list currently active in the Google Ads account, created three campaign concepts, launched one paid campaign (1.93K clicks, 14.3K impressions, $0.41 CPC), and drafted two additional campaigns for future use. He set up GA4 and Google Tag Manager, developed SEO and AEO recommendation documents for both the Bokun site and the Christopher Marley website, and built a comprehensive AI toolbox designed to reduce repetitive marketing and administrative work for the company going forward.

Company Contacts

Allison (Sponsor) was the team's primary point of contact at Exquisite Creatures. She provided access to the social media accounts, shared content from the Seattle Google Drive folder, gave feedback on the Google Ads setup, and shaped the direction of the digital work through ongoing conversations about target audience, geography, and campaign priorities. Most of the practical decisions about what to build and what to deprioritize came out of regular check-ins with her.

Chris (Visit Seattle) became the team's contact at Visit Seattle after Joy reached out through a nonprofit email. He responded within a few days, walked the team through the membership inquiry process, set up a meeting to discuss membership details and benefits, and sent over the steps for creating an account on their extranet. He was the direct contact for getting Exquisite Creatures listed on visitseattle.org.

Neal (King County Metro, Advertising) was the team's contact at King County Metro's advertising division. He met with the team and Allison over Zoom to discuss bus wrap advertising options, including the Ultra Super King format. He mentioned that our timing was good, since most major advertisers had already reserved their World Cup inventory, leaving space available for local businesses.

Diego Ross (JoinBrands Brand Ambassador) served as the team's support contact for JoinBrands. He is reachable at dr@joinbrands.com for questions about campaign setup, platform issues, or collaboration management.

Livy Bak is a content creator based in Utah affiliated with Exquisite Creatures.

Background

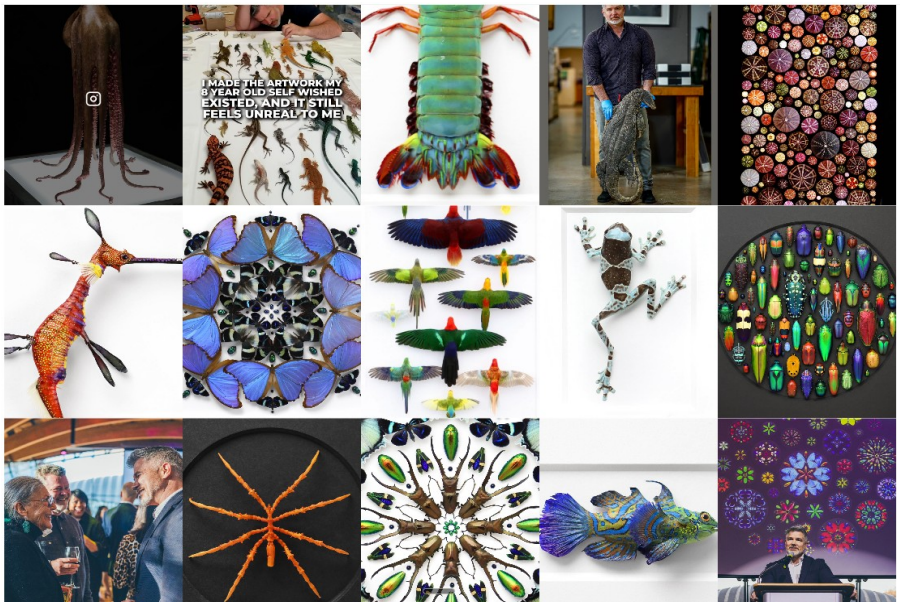
Christopher Marley’s Exquisite Creatures Exhibit has been touring museums across Canada and the United States for over a decade. Past venues include Crystal Bridges and the Houston Museum of Natural Science. Both reported strong attendance. At those locations, the host institution handled all marketing and promotion. The exhibit arrived, the museum promoted it, and the audience came through channels that took years to build.

This year is different. For the first time, Exquisite Creatures is being hosted independently at a 12,000-square-foot waterfront venue in Seattle, near Pike Place Market and the Seattle Aquarium. There is no host museum to lean on. The exhibit has to build its own audience in a city where it has no existing presence.

There was a starting point, though. Christopher Marley has a strong Instagram following, which gives the exhibit some built-in credibility. Allison had Meta ads running and one Google Ad in place before we came on. And in October, a small Seattle-based influencer named @emeraldcityaccess posted about her experience at the exhibit. That video got 2.4 million views and 437,000 likes. People started showing up specifically because of it. One post. That showed us what was possible if the content actually landed.

Still, the exhibit was not hitting its targets. The goal before opening was 500 visitors per day and 52,000 per month. The actual average was under 500 a day. Something needed to change, especially with younger audiences who weren’t on the exhibit’s radar yet.

Our team came in to work on four things: TikTok content, influencer and platform marketing, Google Ads and digital infrastructure, and outreach to Seattle tourism channels. We also picked up on something early in the semester that nobody had acted on yet. A lot of Seattle’s tourist population speaks Mandarin or Cantonese, and there was already organic interest in the exhibit.


I MADE THE ARTWORK MY
8 YEAR OLD SELF WISHED
EXISTED AND IT STILL
FEELS UNREAL TO ME

Process

Our work ran across four tracks: TikTok content, influencer marketing and RedNote, Google Ads and digital infrastructure, and outreach to Visit Seattle and King County Metro. Each had its own set of problems to figure out, but they were all aimed at the same thing.

TikTok and Social Media Content

Before we even logged into the TikTok account, the @emeraldcityaccess video had already set the target. One outside creator posting a genuine reaction got 2.4 million views. The question was whether we could get anywhere close to that from the exhibit's own page.

The account existed when we got there, but barely. About 30 followers, a few posts, no real engagement. Just getting into it was a problem at first. Two-factor authentication meant we needed a code from Allison's phone within 60 seconds every time we logged in.

We started with carousels, similar to Instagram slide posts, using photos from Christopher Marley's Instagram. They looked fine but got almost no traction. So we switched to video. The format that actually worked was a voiceover style, using audio from Christopher's podcast-type Instagram content played over edited clips of the exhibit pieces. Here's how we built those:

1. Pick a voiceover clip from Christopher's Instagram where he talks about a piece or shares a fact about a specimen. Copy the reel link and paste it into Publer to download the video.
2. Open CapCut, upload the reel, and pull out just the audio. Pull video clips from the SEATTLE Google Drive folder separately. Cut them to fit the voiceover.
3. Turn on auto-captions in CapCut. Add low-volume royalty-free background music so it doesn't compete with Christopher's voice.
4. Post directly from CapCut using the built-in TikTok share option. Set location to the exhibit in Seattle.
5. Write a caption that ends with a question, something like 'which piece was your favorite?' Questions push comments, and comments push reach. Add hashtags: #seattle, #seattleartexhibit, #animalart, #christophermarley, #exquisitecreatures, #museumtok, #seattleexhibit, #nature, #ethicalpreservation, #arttok.
6. Schedule posts for 3 p.m. when possible. Saturday nights also consistently performed well based on what the analytics showed.

Once we had momentum on TikTok, Allison added a team member as a manager on the YouTube channel. From there, we downloaded TikTok videos, removed watermarks, and uploaded them as YouTube Shorts with fresh captions and the exhibit website linked in the description.

RedNote and Influencer Marketing

Alongside TikTok, we went after two channels the main account wasn't reaching: RedNote for Chinese-speaking audiences, and structured influencer campaigns through dedicated platforms.

RedNote came from early research. Chinese-speaking users on the platform were already posting about Exquisite Creatures and exhibitions like it in Seattle. The audience was there and interested. Nobody had just given them a direct channel to the exhibit. We created a business account and started posting videos from the shared drive alongside original content built from exhibit photos. Captions mattered a lot on this platform. The Chinese-speaking audience on RedNote responds to playful, attention-grabbing writing, so we wrote accordingly, using hooks that fit that style. We used RedNote's built-in hashtag suggestions and capped posts at 10 hashtags each. We also turned on the automatic translation feature so captions showed up in whatever language the viewer's app was set to.

For influencer marketing, we spent time at the beginning researching which platforms would actually give us control over the process. After looking at several options and meeting with brand representatives, we settled on JoinBrands and Afluencer as the most practical tools for finding local creators and managing collaborations in a trackable way.

On JoinBrands, we launched a campaign and started monitoring applications. When reviewing applicants, we looked at their social media accounts, content style, and engagement numbers. Some creators submitted pitch videos, which made it a lot easier to gauge whether they'd be a good fit for the exhibit's tone. Once we selected someone, we laid out expectations clearly before they started. They had up to 60 days to visit the exhibit and post their content. We reviewed it after posting and could request edits before approving payment. Payment went out once the content had been live for at least 14 days.

We ran a campaign on Afluencer at the same time, reviewing applicants there using the same criteria. We also sent direct outreach to influencers on Instagram, which worked differently. It was more about finding someone whose content already aligned with art, travel, or local experiences, and reaching out in a way that felt personal. Response rates were low, but when someone actually replied, those conversations tended to be more genuine and cheaper than what you'd arrange through a platform.

Digital Infrastructure

The starting observation on the Google side was simple: the exhibit had a Google presence, but it wasn't set up in a way that made it easy to understand what was working or to improve anything over time. We started by auditing what existed and built outward from there.

The work covered three connected things: paid visibility through Google Ads, organic visibility through Google Business Profile and SEO, and an AI toolbox Allison could use to keep marketing work moving internally after we left. Early in the semester we spent time learning how Google Ads, Analytics, and Tag Manager connect to each other, because you can't build useful tracking without understanding the full picture first. One early roadblock was the nonprofit ad route, which required approvals that took longer than expected and eventually led us to shift toward a paid campaign approach. Allison's feedback on audience, geography, price point, and keywords shaped what we actually built, which made the campaigns more usable than a generic setup would have been.

Tourism and Transit Outreach

The Visit Seattle opportunity came from Allison. She had been trying to get a response from them without success. We sent an outreach email through a nonprofit address, heard back from Chris within a few days, and set up a meeting to go over membership structure and benefits. After the meeting, Chris sent instructions for setting up an account on their extranet.

List of Activities

Across the semester, the team's combined work covered TikTok and social media content, RedNote account management, influencer platform campaigns, direct outreach, paid advertising, SEO and AI tooling, and tourism and transit partnerships.

TikTok and Social Media

- TikTok posts: 31 total posts across the semester, a mix of video posts and carousels, produced and managed by Joy, Payton, and Julia.
- YouTube Shorts: 9 total Shorts uploaded to the exhibit's YouTube channel, repurposed from TikTok videos.
- Viral videos: Julia's top video reached 268,300 views; Payton's top video reached 183,500 views. Three additional videos reached 67,000, 70,000, and 190,000 views respectively.
- Analytics review: Performance data tracked weekly, including views, watch time, shares, and follower growth, used to adjust format and posting schedule.

RedNote and Influencer Marketing

- RedNote account: Account created in early March and registered as a business account by end of March. Five posts published within the first month using videos from the shared drive and original content built from exhibit photos. Captions written in a playful, engaging style; built-in translation feature enabled for automatic language matching.
- JoinBrands campaign: One active campaign launched. Received 8 applications. Reviewed applicants based on content quality, engagement rate, and Seattle-local status.
- Afluencer campaign: One active campaign launched. Received 6 applications. Reviewed using the same criteria as JoinBrands.
- Total influencer applicants: 14 across both platforms. 9 were Seattle-based creators, which aligned with the target audience.
- Influencer collaboration, Yana: One influencer selected and approved. She visited the exhibit and created content for both Instagram and TikTok. Her video reached approximately 2,500 views and brought additional visibility to the exhibit.
- Direct Instagram outreach: Reached out individually to influencers focused on art, travel, and local experiences, with personalized messages.

- Brand ambassador meetings: Met with representatives from multiple platforms to evaluate options before committing to JoinBrands and Afluencer.
- Exhibit manager coordination: Coordinated in-person visits with the Exquisite Creatures manager to support influencer collaborations.
- TikTok influencer tracker (Payton to Christy): Initial tracker built by Payton logging TikTok handles, follower counts, and pricing for 13 creators. Christy continued building and managing it.

Digital Infrastructure

- Google Ads: Built the active keyword list, created 3 campaign concepts, launched 1 paid campaign and 1 nonprofit campaign, and built 2 additional campaign drafts for future use.
- GA4 and Google Tag Manager: Both configured and connected to ad campaigns.
- Google Business Profile: Responded to reviews and made improvements to support local search and Maps visibility.
- SEO and AEO documents: Two recommendation documents produced, one from an SEO professional and one from AI-based analysis, covering both the Bokun site and the Christopher Marley website.
- AI toolbox: Researched roughly 8 AI tools and built a decision guide and instruction manual tailored to Exquisite Creatures’ specific use cases.
- AI presentation: Slide deck produced to introduce AI options and demonstrate practical applications.

Tourism and Transit Outreach

- Visit Seattle: Email outreach completed, meeting held, membership process started, exhibit listed on visitseattle.org. Website build in progress.
- King County Metro: Contact made with Neal, Zoom meeting held with Neal and Allison, Ultra Super King bus wrap format researched at an estimated 22,680,153 impressions per campaign. World Cup July window identified.
- Washington Getout Pass: Partnership reviewed in full. Team and sponsor declined after evaluating the terms.

Conclusions

The semester kept pointing back to the same thing: the exhibit has good material to work with, but the systems needed to turn that into consistent audience growth just weren't there when we started. Where we built structure and stayed consistent, the numbers moved. Where we were still figuring things out, the results were more early-stage. Both are honest outcomes.

TikTok and Social Media

TikTok doesn't reward consistency the way you'd expect. We had weeks where nothing performed and then a video would break out completely on its own. What we figured out pretty quickly was that Christopher's voiceovers were driving most of the strong performances. They gave people something to actually engage with in the comments, which is what pushes a video to new audiences. The carousels never did that.

One thing worth knowing going forward: rude or dismissive comments actually boosted our view counts by generating interaction. Responding defensively would have hurt the account. Staying professional and just letting the page look legitimate was the right call, especially during the slower weeks when those comments were most tempting to engage with.

RedNote and Influencer Marketing

RedNote is worth taking seriously. The organic interest was already there before we created the account. Chinese-speaking users in Seattle were posting about the exhibit and similar exhibitions on their own. That's a better starting condition than most new platforms offer, and it tells you the audience is reachable if the account stays active and the content fits the platform's tone.

On the influencer side, JoinBrands and Afluencer are genuinely useful for finding local creators and keeping the collaboration process organized. The limitation is that you're working with whoever applies, which means picking the right person from that pool matters more than the platform itself. Yana's collaboration showed the channel can produce real, fast visibility when the fit is right. One collaboration isn't a pipeline, though. That's still the next thing to build.

Direct outreach has low response rates and that's just the reality of it. But the collaborations that come from direct outreach tend to feel more organic and cost less. Running both approaches at the same time makes sense. They're not competing with each other.

Digital Infrastructure

The clearest takeaway from the Google work is that the exhibit already has search visibility, but there’s no consistent system behind it. The Google Business Profile data showed strong numbers even before we touched anything. The problem is that without tracking, structured campaigns, and regular optimization, visibility like that just leaks out rather than converting into attendance.

The Google ecosystem is more connected than it looks from the outside. Ads, Analytics, Tag Manager, conversion tracking, and Business Profile all affect each other. A lot of what we built wasn’t just campaigns or keyword lists. It was making the system understandable so Allison can actually manage it without starting from scratch every time something needs adjusting.

SEO is easier to evaluate than it is to implement when you don’t have backend access. We know what needs to change on both the Bokun site and the Christopher Marley website. Making the bigger changes requires someone with the right site access to actually follow through. The roadmap is there; execution is what’s left.

The AI toolbox came from watching how much repetitive work Allison is carrying alone. Christopher’s creative work isn’t something AI should be involved in. But the operational stuff, writing copy, drafting outreach messages, organizing information, is exactly what AI handles well. The toolbox was built to make that practical and specific rather than vague.

Tourism and Transit Outreach

Being on Visit Seattle matters. The platform surfaces in exactly the kind of searches tourists run when they’re already in Seattle and trying to figure out what to do. The listing is a starting point, though, not a result by itself. The value depends on whether the exhibit keeps the information accurate and actually tracks what the listing drives.

Impact

The work produced concrete results across all four areas. TikTok went from dormant to one of the exhibit's most active marketing channels. The influencer campaigns produced a completed collaboration and live pipelines on two platforms. Google went from one generic ad to a full campaign system with tracking. And two outreach channels the exhibit didn't have before are now open.

TikTok and Social Media

When we started posting, the @exquisitecreatures account had 34 followers and averaged around 200 views per video. As of March 27, 2026:

- 619,866 total video views
- 613,188 unique users reached
- 6,485 profile visits
- 125,917 total video likes
- 494 total video comments
- 6,425 shares

Every one of those numbers increased by more than 999 percent. The four highest-performing posts generated 264,946, 188,693, 73,369, and 67,904 views respectively. The share numbers are the most telling. Users sharing or saving a video about the exhibit aren't just passively watching. They're bookmarking it for a reason, which is usually intent to visit.

RedNote and Influencer Marketing

The RedNote account launched in early March and was registered as a business account by the end of the month. Business account status gives the profile better algorithmic visibility than a standard personal account. Five videos were published in the first month. The account is early-stage by design since the goal was to get it established and learn the platform before scaling. That foundation is now in place.

On the influencer side, JoinBrands received 8 applications and Afluencer received 6, totaling 14 applicants. Nine were Seattle-based, which is exactly the target. After reviewing content, engagement, and brand fit, we selected Yana. She visited the exhibit, posted content on both Instagram and TikTok, and her video hit around 2,000 views within the first 24 hours and 2,500 total. That's a fast result. It also validates that the channel works when the right creator is involved.

Both platform campaigns are still active and accepting new applicants. The collaboration workflow from application to payment is documented and

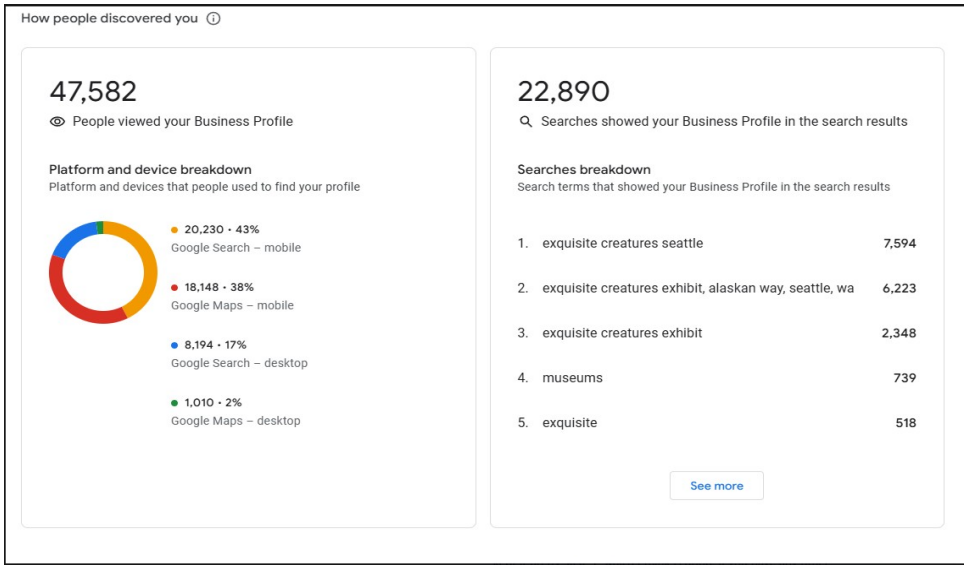
can be handed off without rebuilding anything. And the data from Yana's collaboration gives whoever manages this next a benchmark for what good looks like.

Digital Infrastructure

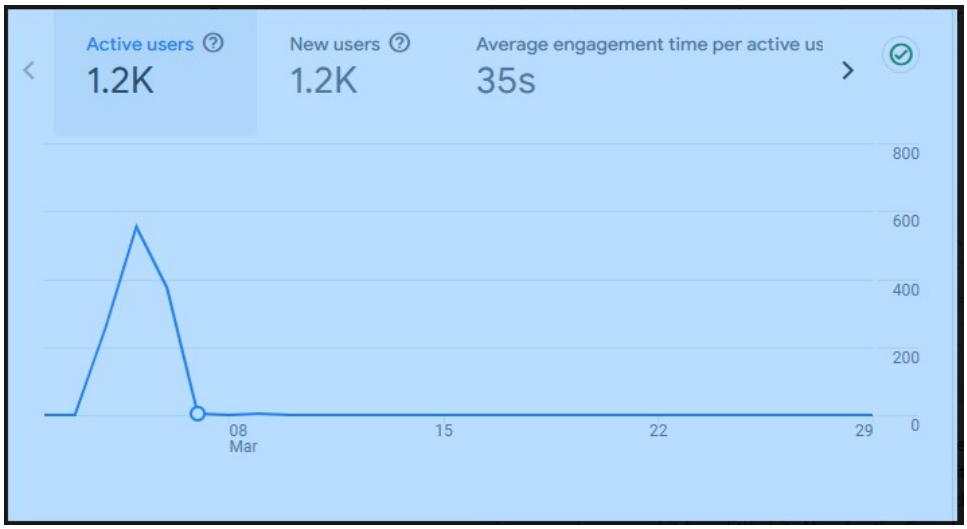
Before this semester, the exhibit had one generic ad, limited tracking, and no documented strategy for search. It now has a functioning Google Ads setup, multiple campaigns built and ready, GA4 and Google Tag Manager connected, an active nonprofit campaign, SEO and AEO recommendation documents, and an AI toolbox with specific instructions written for Exquisite Creatures' actual work.

The paid campaign ran from March 8 through March 26 and generated 1.93K clicks, 14.3K impressions, and an average cost per click of $0.41 on a total spend of $800. The drop at the end reflects a deliberate pause. The nonprofit campaign added 291 clicks and 1.88K impressions independently.

The Google Business Profile data tells a useful story: 36,627 profile interactions, 47,582 profile views, and 22,890 searches that surfaced the exhibit in results. Most of that came from mobile users, specifically 20,230 views from Google Search on mobile and 18,148 from Google Maps on mobile. The audience is finding the exhibit on their phones, which reinforces why keeping the Business Profile current and accurate matters as much as it does.



GA4 captured early data including 1.2K active users, 1.2K new users, an average engagement time of 35 seconds, and 38 tracked events, but stopped recording after the initial implementation. That’s a tag configuration issue, not a structural problem. Identifying it is still useful because the company now knows exactly what to fix before the next campaign runs.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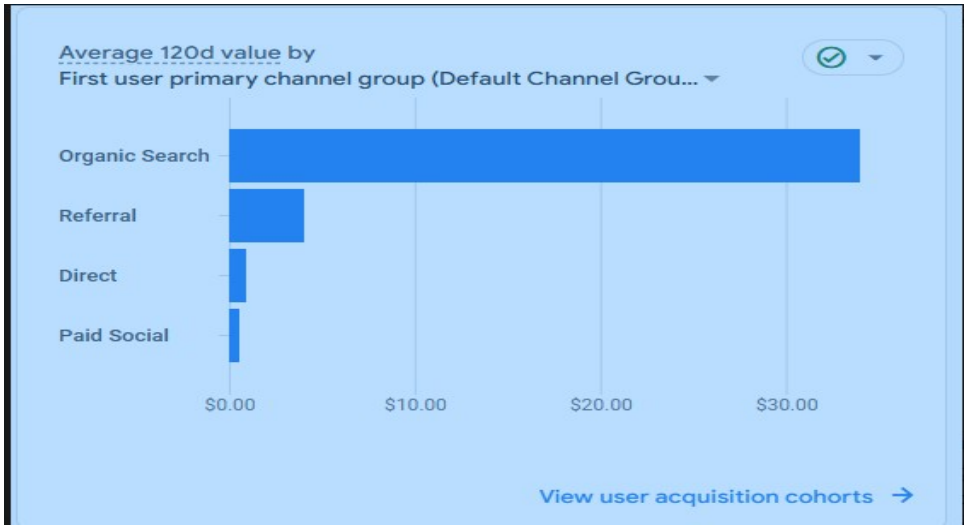
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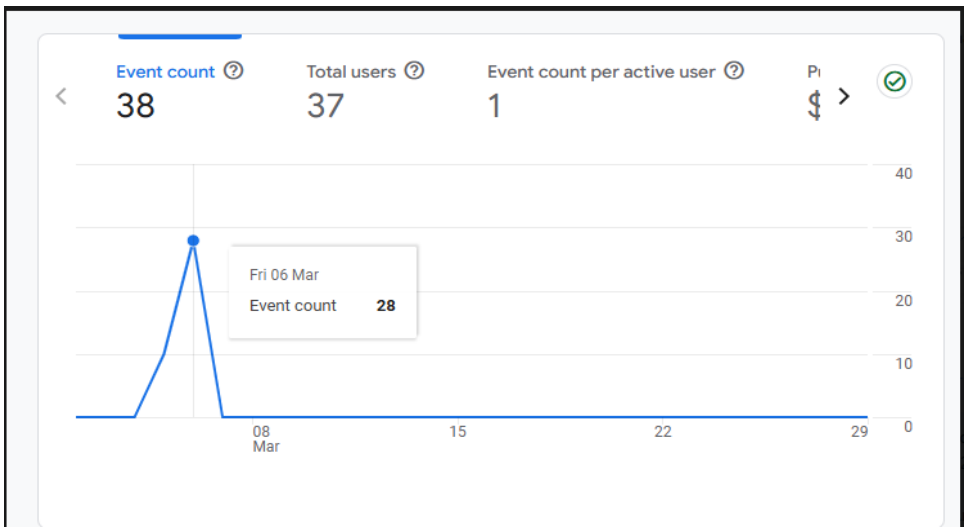
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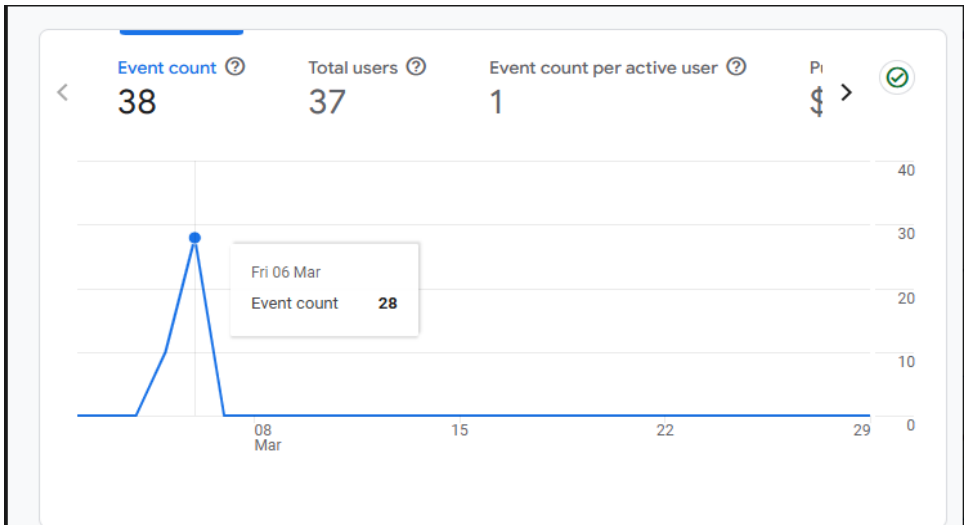

Tourism and Transit Outreach

The Visit Seattle listing puts Exquisite Creatures in front of people who are actively searching for things to do in Seattle. The platform's member social media channels reach over 640,000 people, which creates the possibility of feature placements that would push the exhibit to audiences it's not currently reaching on its own.

The King County Metro conversation opened an opportunity that has a deadline attached to it. World Cup tourist traffic in Seattle peaks in July. The ad inventory for that period is available right now, before other local businesses start competing for what's left. A bus wrap campaign during that window could reach over 22 million people in a city that will be more packed with visitors than it is at almost any other point in the year.

Next Steps

The next 30 to 60 days will determine whether this semester's work compounds or fades. The foundation is there across all four workstreams. Here's what to do with it.

TikTok and Social Media

Keep posting every day. The voiceover format is what drives performance on this account and the data is clear on that. Don't change the approach just because of a slow week. Designate one person to own posting and check analytics weekly. Respond to genuine comments because it builds credibility. Leave dismissive or negative ones alone or handle them professionally. Engaging defensively hurts the account more than the comment does.

The influencer outreach tracker has contacts who were never followed up with and some who showed initial interest. A warm follow-up to someone who already engaged is a faster path to a collaboration than starting new outreach from the beginning.

RedNote and Influencer Marketing

Post on RedNote consistently. The business account status helps with visibility, but only if the account stays active. Keep using playful captions and the built-in hashtag suggestions. Respond to comments regularly. Once the account hits around 1,000 followers, it's worth exploring influencer collaborations on the platform itself to extend reach further into that audience.

On JoinBrands, the active campaign can keep running and be checked periodically for new applicants. Create a new campaign every one to two months so the outreach stays fresh and draws creators who weren't active in the last cycle. The platform lets you manually invite up to two creators per day, which is worth using to target specific creators who are a strong fit rather than just waiting for them to apply.

Afluencer can stay active the same way, checked periodically for new applicants evaluated against the same criteria. Neither platform needs constant attention, just regular enough check-ins that good applicants don't age out without a response.

Keep doing direct outreach on Instagram and TikTok alongside the platform campaigns. The response rates are low and that's just how it is. But the collaborations that come out of direct outreach tend to be cheaper and feel more authentic. Both approaches running at the same time gives the company the best shot at landing the right creators.

Digital Infrastructure

Start using the AI toolbox. Pick one recurring task, find the relevant section of the toolbox, and use it. Admin organization, ad copy drafts, and outreach templates are good places to begin. The value compounds the more it gets used.

Restart the paid Google Ads campaign. The structure is already built. Turn it on, check clicks, impressions, CPC, and search terms every week, and adjust based on what the data shows. Be careful with Google's automated recommendations. They're built to increase spend, not necessarily to improve results.

Fix the GA4 tracking issue. The tag likely stopped firing after the initial setup. Once it's working consistently, the company will finally have reliable data for evaluating both ad performance and organic traffic from SEO work. Right now that data gap is making it harder to know what's actually driving visits.

Get started on the SEO recommendations. The simpler fixes, like correcting the header hierarchy on the website and adding alt tags to images, don't require any backend access. Assign someone to own the changes that do require it so they don't just sit in a document forever.

Tourism and Transit Outreach

Finish the Visit Seattle website build through the extranet. Once it's live, set up referral tracking in GA4 so there's actual data on how much traffic the listing generates.

Commit to the King County Metro bus wrap campaign before the World Cup window closes. The reason that inventory is still available is that the big advertisers already took what they wanted. That window won't stay open.

For a future intern team: TikTok posting and analytics, RedNote growth, influencer campaign management on both platforms, Google Ads refinement, and backend SEO implementation.

User Guide

This guide covers all four workstream areas: TikTok and social media, RedNote and influencer marketing, Google digital infrastructure, and website SEO. Each section is written for whoever is taking over or continuing that work. Start with Next Steps to figure out what to prioritize, then come back here for the how.

TikTok and Social Media Guide

Purpose:

Covers how to manage the @exquisitecreatures TikTok account on an ongoing basis, including the content workflow, posting strategy, and what to do when engagement dips.

Description:

The account has an established content format (voiceover-style videos using Christopher's audio over edited exhibit clips), an editing workflow built around CapCut and Publer, and a posting schedule tested over two months. The YouTube channel mirrors TikTok content via Shorts.

Instructions:

7. Post every day. Daily posting keeps the account active and visible in the algorithm. Accounts that post in bursts and go quiet lose momentum that is hard to get back.
8. To create a video: copy a reel link from Christopher's Instagram, paste it into Publer to download, upload to CapCut, extract the audio, add exhibit clips from the SEATTLE Google Drive folder, enable auto-captions, add low-volume instrumental background music, and export directly to TikTok via CapCut's share feature.
9. Set location to the exhibit in Seattle before posting. Write a caption ending with a question to prompt comments. Add hashtags: #seattle, #seattleartexhibit, #animalart, #christophermarley, #exquisitecreatures, #museumtok, #seattleexhibit, #nature, #ethicalpreservation, #arttok.
10. Schedule posts for 3 p.m. when possible. Saturday nights also perform well based on semester analytics.
11. For YouTube Shorts: download the TikTok video, remove the TikTok watermark, upload to YouTube Shorts, write a fresh caption using an AI tool for variation, and include the exhibit website link in the description.

12. Check analytics weekly. Most useful metrics: views by video (which format is working), new followers (what converts viewers), and watch time (where people drop off).

Limitations:

Views won't grow in a straight line. Keep posting at the same quality and cadence during slow weeks. Accounts that pause during flat periods lose algorithmic momentum and take longer to recover than those that kept going. Don't change the strategy because of a single bad week.

Support:

Publer: publer.com. CapCut: capcut.com. TikTok analytics: TikTok Studio (in-app or studio.tiktok.com). Influencer outreach tracker linked in appendix.

RedNote and Influencer Marketing Guide

Purpose:

Covers how to maintain and grow the RedNote account and how to manage ongoing influencer campaigns through JoinBrands and Afluencer, as well as direct outreach.

Description:

Two active components: the RedNote account targeting Chinese-speaking audiences in Seattle, and influencer campaigns on JoinBrands and Afluencer. Both are set up and operational. What they need is consistent management and periodic new activity.

RedNote:

13. Post consistently using videos from the shared drive or existing social media content. Content built from exhibit photos also works.
14. Write captions that are playful and attention-grabbing. This is the style that performs with Chinese-speaking audiences on the platform. Captions that read like press releases don't work here.
15. Enable RedNote's built-in translation feature so captions show up in the viewer's app language. This should be on for every post.
16. Add relevant hashtags using RedNote's built-in suggestion tool. Cap at 10 per post.
17. Respond to comments regularly. Engagement tells the platform the account is active, which improves visibility.
18. Once the account reaches around 1,000 followers, start exploring influencer collaborations on the platform to extend reach further.

JoinBrands:

19. Monitor the active campaign regularly and review new applications as they come in.
20. Evaluate applicants based on content quality, engagement rate, whether they're Seattle-based, and overall fit with the exhibit's brand. Pitch videos from applicants are especially useful for getting a sense of personality and tone.
21. Approve selected influencers and communicate expectations clearly before they begin. Influencers have up to 60 days to visit the exhibit and post their content.
22. Review the submitted content after posting. Request edits if needed before approving payment.
23. Release payment only after the content has been live for at least 14 days.
24. Create a new campaign every one to two months to keep outreach fresh and attract new creators.
25. Use the manual invitation feature (up to 2 per day) to proactively invite creators who are a strong fit rather than waiting for them to apply.

Support:

For JoinBrands questions, contact brand ambassador Diego Ross at dr@joinbrands.com.

Afluencer:

26. Keep campaigns active and check periodically for new applicants.
27. Evaluate applicants using the same criteria as JoinBrands: content quality, engagement rate, local relevance, and fit.
28. Select influencers that align with the exhibit's audience and visual style.

Direct Outreach:

Identify influencers focused on art, travel, food, or local Seattle experiences. Strong engagement relative to follower count matters more than follower count alone.

Reach out through direct message or email in a way that feels personal rather than templated. Reference something specific about their content so it's obvious the message wasn't mass-sent.

Limitations:

Direct outreach response rates are low. That’s expected, not a sign the strategy isn’t working. Platform-based campaigns give more consistent volume; direct outreach is for landing a specific creator who is exactly right. Run both at the same time.

AI Toolbox Guide

Purpose:

Helps the company understand which AI tools are most useful for Exquisite Creatures’ actual work and how to start using them practically.

Description:

The toolbox introduces multiple AI tools, explains what each does, shows where it fits into the company’s workflow, and provides specific prompts and instructions written for Exquisite Creatures. It works as both a decision guide and an instruction manual.

Instructions:

29. Start with the overview section to understand what tools are included and what each is built for.
30. Identify the task you want to improve: writing ad copy, drafting outreach messages, summarizing SEO recommendations, organizing admin tasks.
31. Open the section for the tool that fits that task. Read the setup instructions and use the recommended prompts. They’re written specifically for Exquisite Creatures and should produce usable output with minimal adjustment.
32. Test the tool on a low-stakes task before relying on it for anything important.
33. Keep a human reviewing the outputs. AI produces plausible-sounding errors, especially on factual or brand-specific content.

Limitations:

Don’t give any AI agent full account access until you understand how it behaves with limited permissions. Keep access compartmentalized. Be skeptical of vendors presenting themselves as AI experts. A lot of what gets sold as sophisticated AI is straightforward automation with a markup.

Google Ads Workflow Guide

Purpose:

Covers how to run, adjust, and evaluate the paid search campaigns built during the semester. The structure is in place; this guide explains how to keep it working.

Description:

The existing setup includes three campaign concepts, one active paid campaign, one nonprofit campaign, a keyword list, and connections to GA4 and Google Tag Manager. Campaigns can be turned on, monitored, adjusted, and paused without rebuilding from scratch.

Instructions:

34. Before activating any campaign, review targeting, geography, keywords, audience, and budget. Confirm they still match the exhibit's current situation.
35. Verify that GA4 and Google Tag Manager are connected and recording before turning any campaign on. Running ads without working tracking means you won't know what the spend accomplished.
36. Review clicks, impressions, CPC, and any available conversion data weekly.
37. Read Google's automated recommendations carefully before applying them. They're optimized to increase spend, not necessarily to improve results. Apply them selectively.
38. Use performance data to improve keyword lists, ad copy, and targeting gradually. Small consistent improvements outperform periodic rebuilds.

Limitations:

The GA4 tag appears to have stopped firing consistently after the initial setup. Fix that before drawing conclusions from the analytics data. Avoid deleting and rebuilding campaign elements. Keep the existing structure and improve it incrementally.

Website and SEO Guide

Purpose:

Addresses the most actionable improvements to the Exquisite Creatures website and Google Business Profile to improve search visibility.

Description:

The website currently starts its header structure at H4, skipping H1 through H3 entirely. Search engines use H1 and H2 tags to understand what a page is about. Without them, the site is harder to rank and harder for users to scan.

Fixing the Header Structure:

39. Use Google Keyword Planner or Semrush to find the search terms people use when looking for exhibits in Seattle. Focus on terms with high volume, moderate competition, and direct relevance. Starting examples: ‘Seattle art exhibits,’ ‘Exquisite Creatures exhibit Seattle,’ ‘things to do in Seattle.’
40. Set the H1 on each main page to reflect its primary topic. For the homepage, something like ‘Exquisite Creatures Seattle’ is clean and specific.
41. Use H2 tags for major page sections: ‘Now Open on the Seattle Waterfront,’ ‘About Christopher Marley,’ ‘Hours and Visitor Information,’ ‘Previous Exhibits and Locations.’
42. Work down through H3 and H4 for sub-sections as needed, maintaining a logical hierarchy.

Keyword and Backlink Strategy:

43. Run the exhibit’s URL through Semrush to see what terms are already driving traffic and where the gaps are.
44. Build backlinks by getting the exhibit’s URL placed on relevant external sites: local event listings, travel blogs, news articles, and partner websites.
45. Add alt tags to all images on the website. Alt tags are descriptive text that help search engines index the page and improve accessibility.
46. Make sure the information on the website matches the Google Business Profile exactly. Hours, address, and contact details should be consistent across both.

Google Business Profile:

47. Add new photos and videos to the profile at least once every two months. Team photos, exhibit interior, venue exterior, and visitor content all count. Consistent updates signal activity to Google.
48. Post regular updates using the Post button. ‘Update’ for general news, ‘Event’ for special programming, ‘Offer’ for discounts or group pricing. Each post tells Google the profile is active.
49. Respond to all reviews on both Google and TripAdvisor. Engagement with reviewers improves visibility on both platforms. Pre-written response templates are linked in the appendix.

Appendix

The following links provide access to the tools, platforms, accounts, and documents referenced throughout this report.

- **Exquisite Creatures TikTok:** https://www.tiktok.com/@exquisitecreatures
- **Exquisite Creatures YouTube:** http://www.youtube.com/@exquisitecreaturesexhibit
- **Visit Seattle Listing:** https://visitseattle.org/members/biophilia-museums-and-exhibits-of-art-nature-and-science/
- **Influencer Outreach Tracker (Excel):** https://byu-my.sharepoint.com/:x:/r/personal/pbwall_byu_edu/Documents/Influencer%20Outreach.xlsx
- **TripAdvisor Pre-Written Responses:** https://docs.google.com/document/d/1p_heJ9XJ_BYCJrHowvpUuj95EHM1rIluey_0MhZ9Wlo/edit
- **King County Bus Impressions Data:** https://docs.google.com/document/d/1XK_J6R4qW5XYyk3I2r9-9wBdsWmokoyTuOf5yvTVDOg/edit
- **Publer (video/photo downloader):** https://publer.com/tools/photo-video-downloader
- **VistaSocial (post scheduling):** https://vistasocial.com/login
- **CapCut (video editing):** https://www.capcut.com
- **JoinBrands:** https://www.joinbrands.com
- **Afluencer:** https://afluencer.com
- **JoinBrands Support, Diego Ross:** dr@joinbrands.com